

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1315

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend our Tennessee veterans.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal safety and concerns to ensure our individual and collective freedom; and

WHEREAS, the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who have, throughout the years, entered military service to defend this great nation; and

WHEREAS, veterans represent a distinct and honored segment of our population—individuals who have voluntarily stepped forward to serve our country. Their status is not incidental or assigned; it is earned through sacrifice, service, and commitment; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee knows that veterans are a uniquely deserving group of persons whose service has directly contributed to the protection of our freedoms and way of life; and

WHEREAS, veteran status is earned, not an inherent characteristic, and acknowledged accordingly in state policy discussions as veterans deserve our respect, recognition, and fair consideration in public life, including employment opportunities; and

WHEREAS, veterans represent a very small portion of the population—approximately 1 percent—who raise their hand to serve, often at great personal cost. Their service often includes sacrifice of time with family, career opportunities, personal safety, and, in some cases, long-term health; and

WHEREAS, military service is not borne by the individual alone but by the entire family and especially spouses of service members, including active-duty spouses, who make ongoing sacrifices through frequent relocations, career disruption, and the demands of military life; and

WHEREAS, we should pay special homage to veteran spouses, particularly those Gold Star spouses who have lost a service member in the line of duty, whose sacrifice is permanent and enduring, and spouses of veterans who have a 100 percent service-connected disability, many of whom serve as caregivers and continue to bear the weight of that service long after it ends; and

WHEREAS, the causes of peace and freedom have been upheld by these valiant individuals among us, no longer in uniform, and we should all be inspired to dedicate ourselves to the ideals that our fellow citizens served and sacrificed to protect; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor our Tennessee veterans for their service, extending our gratitude for the contributions they made to further freedom and the future of the United States of America, for they are deserving of the full support of all citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.